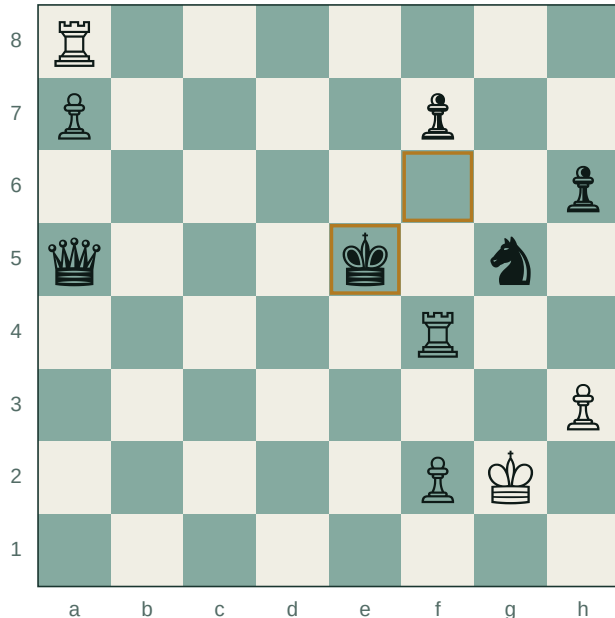


# Clearance tactics: White, move 47

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 46...Ke5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**47. Re8+ Kxf4 48. a8=Q Qxa8+ 49. Rxa8**

**47.Re8+** Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **47...Kxf4**.

**48.a8=Q** The pawn moves from a7 to a8. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **48...Qxa8+**.

**49.Rxa8** The rook captures the queen on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on e5. Geometrically undefended: queen on a5. Check for tactical protection.